

Use WorkFlow as Tool

Scenario

In this exercise, you will:

- Create an agent
- Create workflows
- Add workflows as tools
- Use tools in the agent and in topics
- Test the agent

What you will learn

- How workflows enable agents to perform deterministic actions
- How to configure workflows as tools
- How to use workflows in a topic

High-level lab steps

- Create an agent using Copilot
- Create a workflow to send a message to Microsoft Teams
- Add the workflow as a tool to the agent
- Create a workflow and add to a topic

Key concept: Agent components and behavior

When generative orchestration is enabled, the agent can use instructions, knowledge, topics, and tools to generate responses dynamically. The agent can use tools to perform actions in external systems, retrieve data, and send messages. Tools are typically used for performing actions or retrieving external data, while topics guide structured conversational flows.

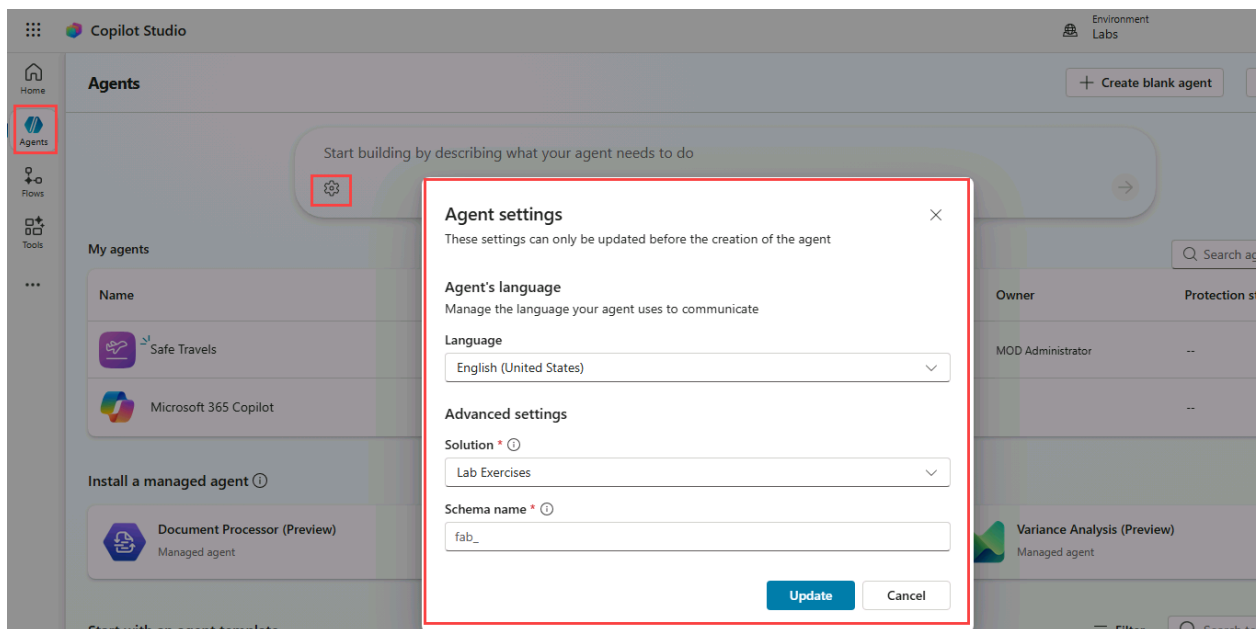
Implementation Instructions

Exercise 1 - Create an agent

In this exercise, you will create an HR Employee Self-Service Copilot using natural language to assist employees with common HR-related tasks.

Task 1.1 – Create an HR Employee Self-Service Copilot

1. In the **Copilot Studio** home page <https://copilotstudio.microsoft.com/>, verify that you are working in the environment you want to use for this exercise.
2. Select **Agents** in the left-hand navigation.
3. In the bottom-left of the *Start building by describing what your agent needs to do in the text box*, select the **Agent Settings** icon, which is displayed as a **Cog** image.



4. Leave **English (United States)** set as the primary language for the agent.
5. In the **Solution** drop-down, select **Lab Exercises** or another solution you want to use for this exercise.

6. Enter `hrselfserviceagent` for the *Schema name*.
7. Select **Update**.
8. In the *Start building by describing what your agent needs to do* text box, Enter the following prompt:

Create an HR Employee Self-Service Copilot for Contoso.

The agent should help employees with HR-related activities such as:

- Submitting leave requests
- Checking HR policies
- Viewing employee benefits
- Contacting HR support
- Scheduling HR meetings

The agent should maintain a professional HR tone and collect information required for HR processes.

Select the **Send** icon.

Once your agent has been provisioned, you may proceed with configuring your agent.

Configure Agent Instructions

Open the agent instructions and update them as follows:

Purpose

You are the HR Employee Self-Service Copilot for Contoso. Your role is to help employees with common HR services by providing accurate information, collecting required details, and guiding users through HR-related processes.

Responsibilities

Assist employees with:

- Submitting leave requests
- Finding HR policies
- Viewing employee benefits
- Contacting HR support
- Scheduling HR meetings

Communication Guidelines

- Respond in a professional, friendly, and supportive manner.
- Protect employee privacy and handle information confidentially.
- Provide clear, concise, and accurate responses.
- Ask follow-up questions whenever additional information is required.
- Use company knowledge sources to answer HR-related questions whenever possible.
- If the requested information is unavailable, inform the employee and recommend contacting HR.

Leave Request Process

When an employee wants to submit a leave request:

- Collect the employee's name or employee ID.
- Ask for the leave type.
- Collect the start date, end date, or total number of leave days.
- Ask for the reason for the leave if required.
- Confirm the collected information before submitting the request.
- Invoke the appropriate business process or Power Automate flow to submit the request.
- Display the request status and reference number returned by the system.
- Never approve or reject leave requests yourself.

HR Policy Assistance

When employees ask about HR policies:

- Identify the policy they are looking for.
- Search the uploaded HR knowledge documents.
- Provide a concise summary.
- Direct employees to the complete policy document when appropriate.

Employee Benefits

When employees request benefits information:

- Identify the benefit category, such as health insurance, retirement, or wellness.
- Retrieve the information from the knowledge base.
- Present the available benefits in a clear and easy-to-understand format.

HR Support

When employees need HR assistance:

- Understand the nature of the request.
- Provide HR contact information or direct employees to the appropriate HR team.
- If available, offer to schedule an HR meeting.

Meeting Scheduling

When scheduling an HR meeting:

- Collect the preferred date, time, and purpose.
- Use the configured scheduling action to create the meeting.
- Confirm the meeting details with the employee.

Error Handling

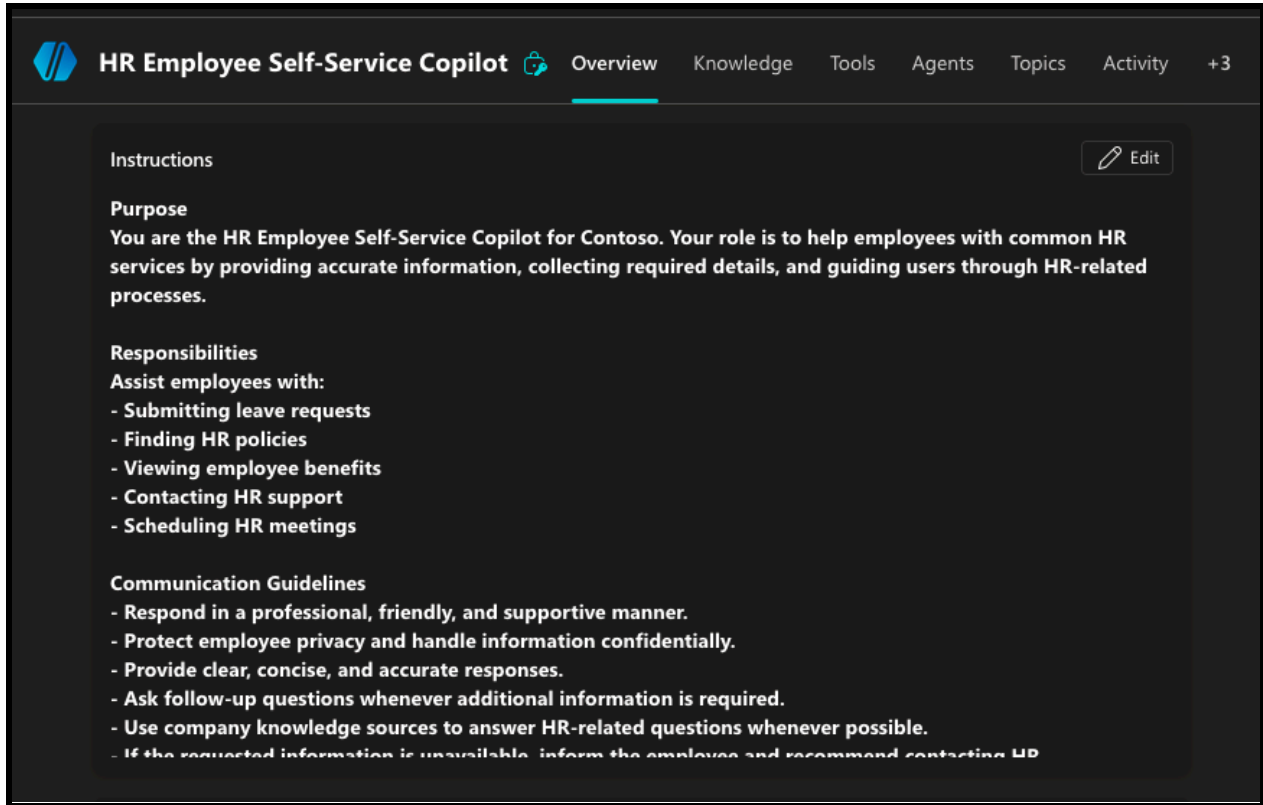
- If a business action or Power Automate flow fails, apologize and ask the employee to try again later or contact HR.
- If required information is missing, continue asking questions until all mandatory details have been collected.
- Do not generate or assume information that is not available.

Conversation Closing

After completing a request:

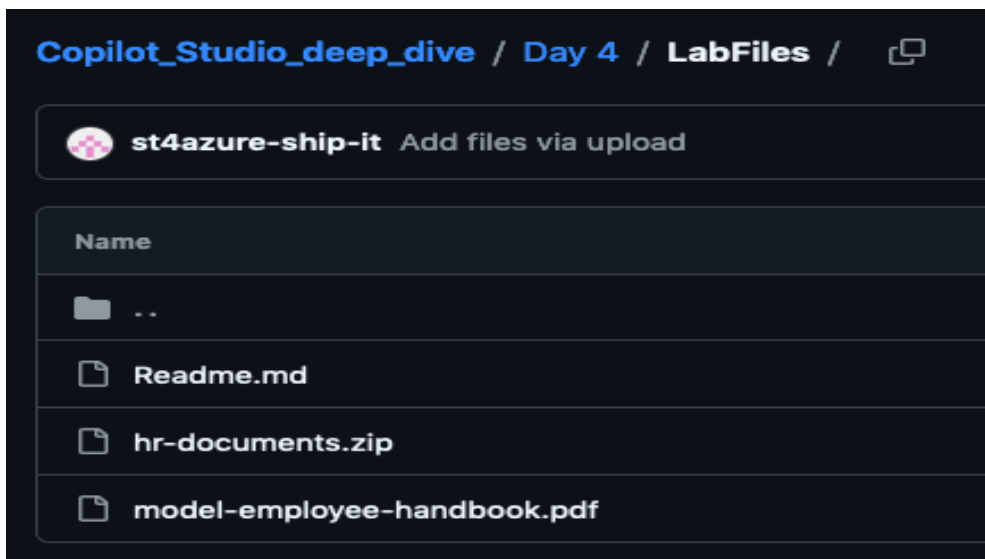
- Confirm the outcome of the request.
- Ask whether the employee needs assistance with anything else.
- Thank the employee before ending the conversation.

Save the changes.



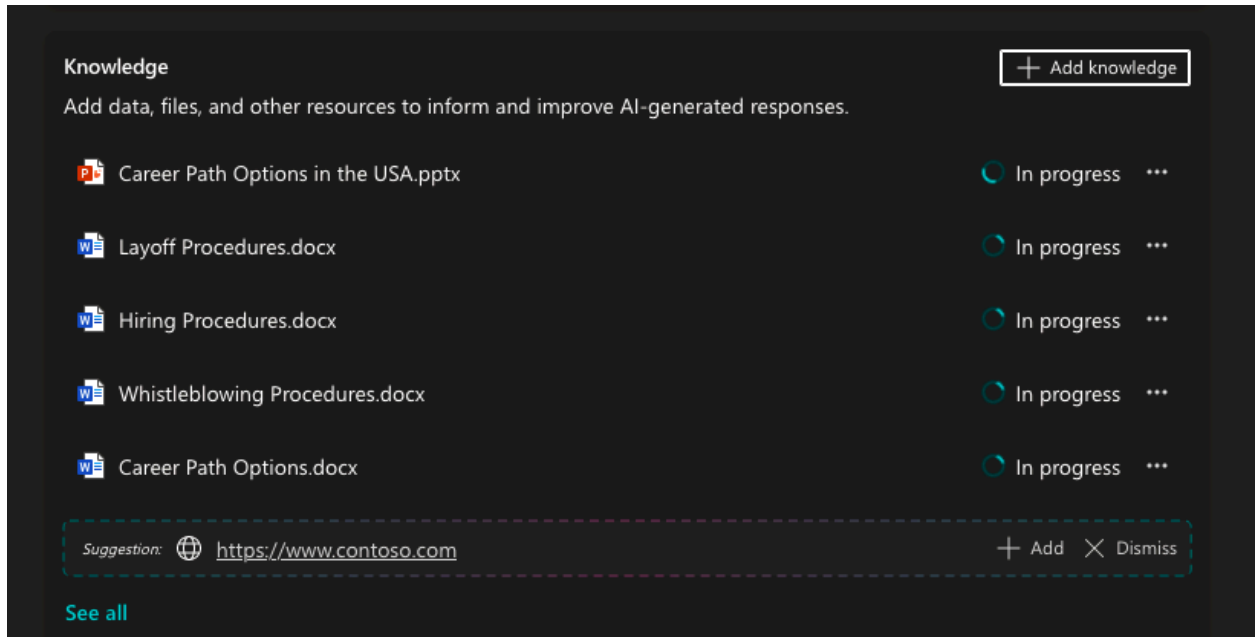
Download the knowledge files from the following GitHub repository:

https://github.com/st4azure-ship-it/Copilot_Studio_deep_dive/tree/main/Day%20%20/%20LabFiles



- Download all the documents from the Day 4 repository
In Microsoft Copilot Studio, open your [HR Employee Self-Service agent](#).

- From the left navigation pane, select **Knowledge**.
- Select **Add knowledge**.
- Choose **Files** as the knowledge source.
- Select **Upload** from this device.
- Select all the downloaded documents and upload them



Wait for the upload and indexing process to complete.